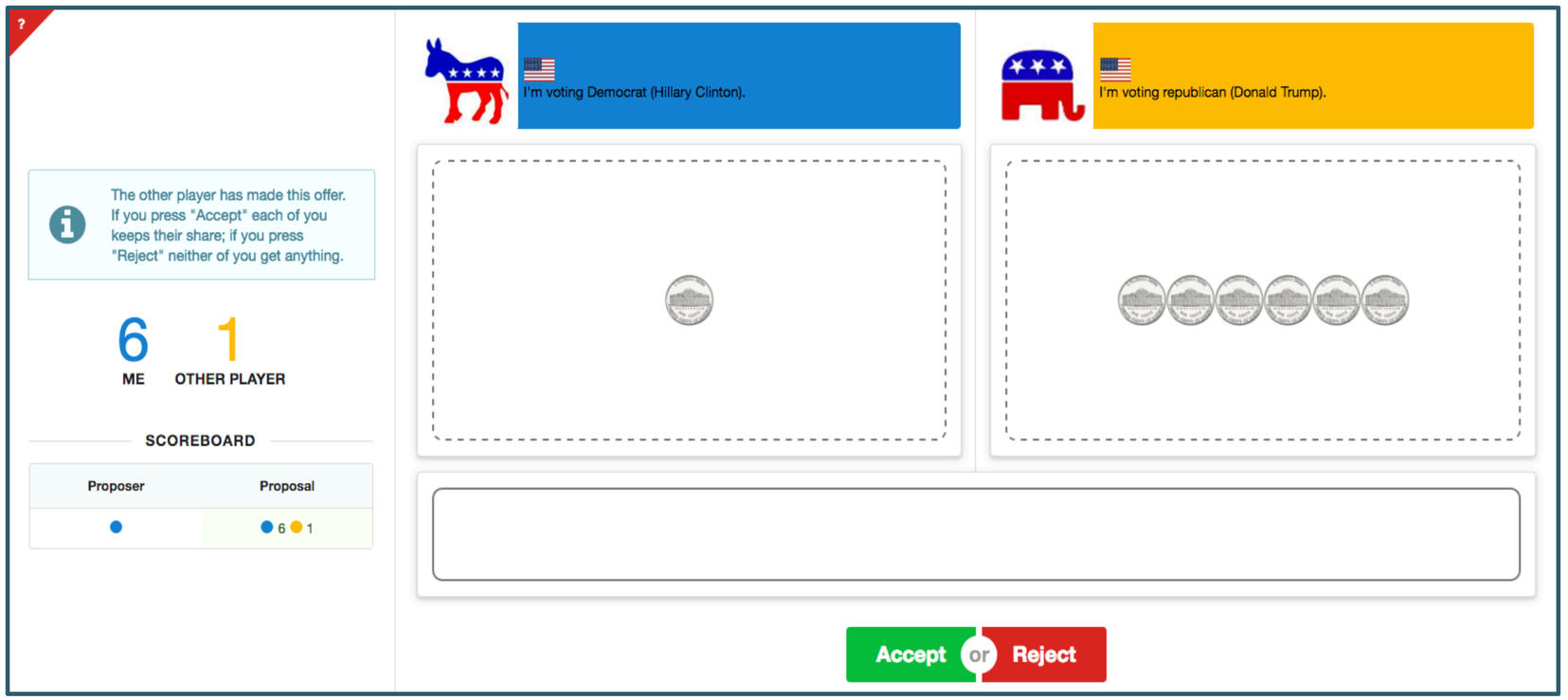
Introducing Cut: An online platform for conducting synchronous interactive experiments

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Introduction

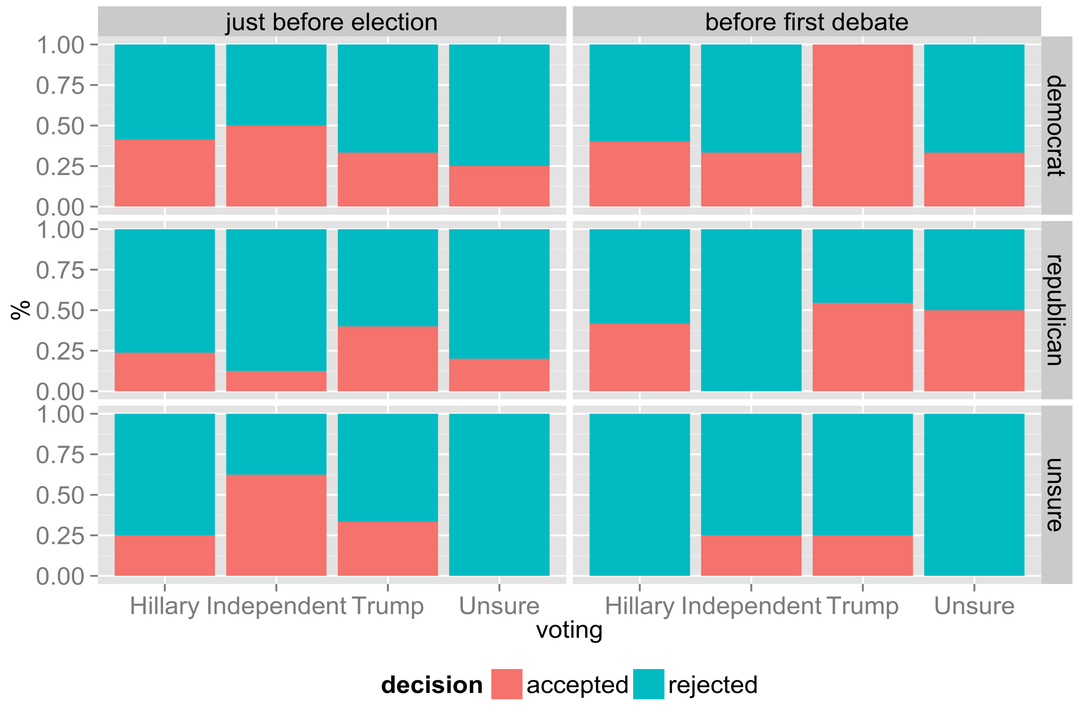
- Cut (https://cut.social) is a survey platform with the capability to incorporate interactive tasks or games that are used in research on **cooperation, fairness, trust, altruism,** etc.
- Cut significantly reduces time and costs of running experiments that require multiple participants to interact simultaneously Moreover, it ensures an important constraint, **participant anonymity,** is met.
- Experimenters can choose from various game templates and customize them. For example, in an **Ultimatum Game,** number of rounds and the type/number of resources can be customized.
- Also, any game can be run as a multiple player game where a participant is matched with another participant, or as a single player game, where participants are matched with **experimenter-defined agents**, with controlled profile information and behavior.
- In addition, conventional survey elements (e.g. multiple-choice questions) can be added before or after the interactive task.
- Finally, the platform is integrated with **Amazon MTurk**; the subject recruitment and payments are streamlined.



A screenshot of the game board. This is a two-round Ultimatum Game where the participant (left panel) plays against customized agent who is voting for the Republican candidate and behaves selfishly (strategy).

Case study

- **The goal of this study was to investigate how American voters would behave in a 2-round Ultimatum Game when interacting with people who were either (a) voting for the same candidates as theirs, or (b) an opposing candidate or (c) were undecided.**
- **Participants first indicated who they wanted to vote for, then they completed three practice rounds. Next they were matched randomly with either ingroup voter, outgroup voter, or an undecided voter.**
- **We also manipulated the behavior of the agent. It could either behave fairly (split *n* items into two if even, take *[n/2]+1* if odd), or it could behave selfishly, and only give away 1 item to the other party.**
- **The roles were assigned randomly, so half of the participants were Responders on first round and Proposers on round two and the other half were Proposers in round 1 and Responder in round 2.**
- **We collected two datasets: one before the first presidential debate between the candidates, and one starting a few days before the election.**
- **The sample was n=800 (games), in 5 days. In each round the total amount at stake was $0.35. Participants were paid bonuses in addition to a flat $0.15 participation fee. That amonts to $0.5 per participant. Responses to selfish offers are shown on the right.**



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